

MIR

Space station

In 1990, quail chicks hatched on Mir became the first animals born in space.

Cargo supply craft

Core module

Solar panels supplied power, and Mir suffered power cuts in Earth's shadow

The world's first large space station, Mir grew as cosmonauts added extra modules. An international crew – including astronauts from the UK, France, and Japan – carried out many experiments in the weightless environment of Mir. This space station was home to 125 astronauts during its lifetime, until it was de-orbited on 23 March 2001.

DATA FILE



SIZE: 33 m (108 ft)



LAUNCH DATE: 20 February 1986



MISSION DURATION: 15 years, 1 month, 3 days (de-orbited)



SPACE AGENCY: Russian space program